VCM Training Manual

Section 5.1 – Data Collection & Reporting Requirements

Value Chain Managers (**VCM**s) play a critical role in the SCL farmer ecosystem. In addition to providing advisory services to farmers, VCMs are responsible for collecting accurate, timely, and complete data about farmers and their farming activities using the **Farmsville** mobile application.



This data enables SCL to understand farmer activities, forecast production, verify regenerative agriculture practices, aggregate produce for markets, and support farmers with finance and insurance services.

Accurate data collection also allows SCL to strengthen farmer participation in commercial markets and improve decision-making across the entire agricultural value chain.

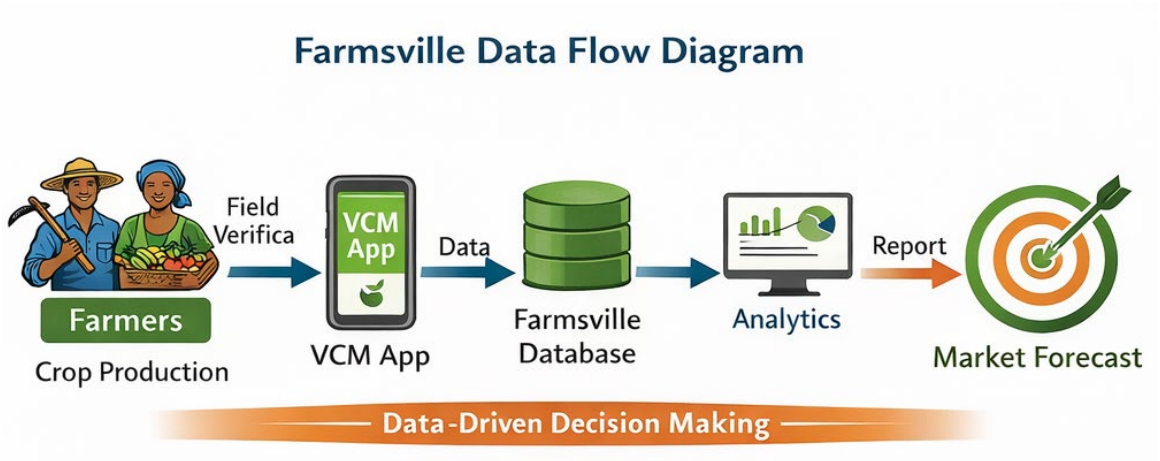
The following guidelines explain what data must be collected, when it must be collected, how accuracy should be ensured, and why this information is important for farmer business development.

5.1.1 What Data Must Be Collected

Value Chain Managers collect **two main categories of data**:

1. Static Data (Farmer Registration Data)

Static data refers to information that defines the farmer and the household environment and the specific plots of land they practice farming on. This data is usually collected **once during farmer registration** and updated only when necessary – e.g. *such as when a farmer changes their farm plot(s)*.



Examples of static data include:

- *Farmer identity information*
- *Contact information*
- *Household demographic information*
- *Household economic indicators*
- *Financial access and banking status*
- *Farm ownership information*
- *Farm location and mapping*
- *Farm plot identification*
- *Types of farming activities practiced*

This information forms the **foundation of the farmer profile** within the **Farmsville** system.

2. Dynamic Data (Seasonal Farming Activity Data)

Dynamic data refers to information that is collected **throughout the farming season** to track agricultural activities and production outcomes.

Dynamic data allows **SCL** and **VCM**s to understand how the farmer is managing the farm and how crop production is progressing over time.

The farming activity cycle tracked within the **Farmsville** system follows the sequence below:

1. **Seed Acquisition**
2. **Land Preparation**
3. **Planting**
4. **Germination**
5. **Crop Management**
6. **Harvest**

Each of these activities must be recorded as they occur during the farming season.

In addition, **Regenerative Practice Monitoring** must be conducted at **every stage** of this cycle.

This ensures that farmers supported by SCL are adopting regenerative agricultural practices such as:

- Use of organic seed sources
- Seed banks from previous harvests
- Reduced soil disturbance
- Crop diversity and polyculture
- Soil cover and mulching
- Agroforestry integration

Regenerative Practice Monitoring is therefore a **continuous observation and reporting process**, not a separate stage – hence dynamic.

5.1.2 When Data Must Be Collected

Data must be collected at **specific points during the farming season**.

Static Data Collection

Static data is collected:

- When a farmer is first registered in the system
- When a VCM begins working with a farmer
- Whenever significant changes occur in the farmer's profile

Examples of updates include:

- Change in household composition
- Change in phone number or contact information
- Change in farm location or ownership

Dynamic Data Collection

Dynamic data must be collected throughout the farming season according to the farming activity timeline.

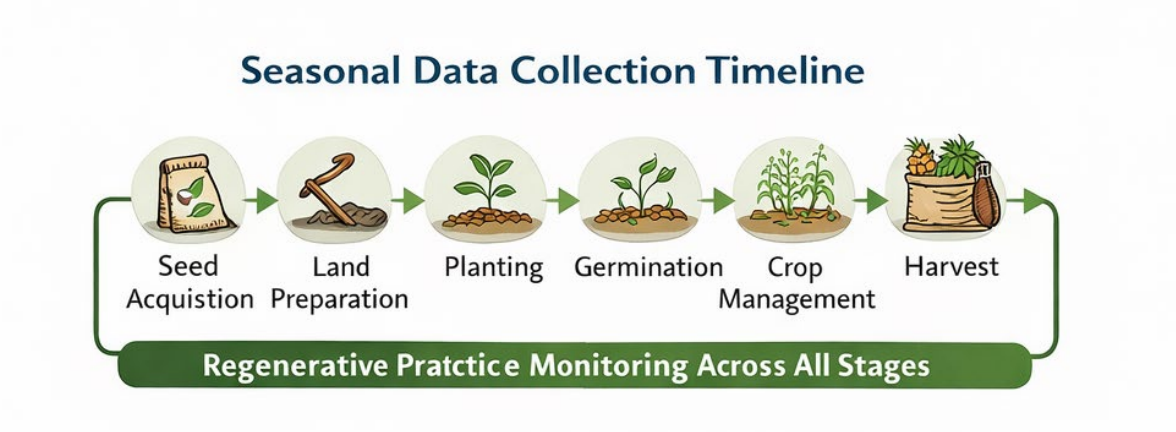
VCMs should capture information during farm visits at the following stages:

Seed Acquisition Stage:

Before the farming season begins, **VCM**s record:

- Source of seed

- Whether seeds came from farmer seed banks
- Quantity of seeds obtained
- Whether the seeds are organic or purchased
- Adoption of regenerative agriculture practices



Land Preparation Stage:

Before planting begins, **VCM**s confirm:

- Land preparation has occurred
- Farm size prepared matches expected area
- Land preparation occurred within the recommended planting calendar
- Adoption of regenerative agriculture practices

Planting Stage

During planting, VCMs record:

- Crops planted
- Intercropping combinations
- Planting patterns
- Seed quantities used
- Adoption of regenerative agriculture practices

Germination Stage

After planting, **VCM**s verify:

- Germination success
- Crop establishment

- Crop population levels
- Adoption of regenerative agriculture practices

Crop Management Stage

During crop growth, **VCM**s monitor:

- Weed management
- Bio-input application
- Crop health conditions
- Adoption of regenerative agriculture practices

Harvest Stage

At harvest time, **VCM**s record:

- Harvest dates
- Number of harvest events
- Quantity harvested
- Crop yield estimates
- Adoption of regenerative agriculture practices

Some crops may require **multiple harvest recordings**, and each harvest should be captured separately.

5.1.3 How to Ensure Accuracy and Why Accuracy Matters

Accurate data collection is essential for the reliability and usefulness of the **Farmsville** system.

VCMs must ensure that all information recorded represents the **actual conditions on the farm**.

To ensure accuracy, VCMs should follow these practices:

- **Collect data** during **physical** visits to the farm whenever possible
- **Verify farming activities** through **direct observation** and document using the Farmsville application
- Use **GPS location** capture through the Farmsville application
- Use timestamp verification through the **Farmsville** application when recording activities.
- Capture **photographic evidence** where required
- Record information **immediately** during the visit

VCMs should avoid relying on memory or recording information after leaving the farm this will be monitored and the associated data rejected as unreliable.

Why Accuracy Matters

The **Farmsville** system uses the collected data to build a **timeline of farming activities**.

This timeline allows SCL to check whether reported farming activities make sense.

For example:

If the system records:

Land preparation → planting → germination → crop management

But harvest output is **significantly lower than expected**, this may indicate:

- **incorrect data** collection
- **crop damage** that was not recorded
- **missing crop** management information

When data is **inaccurate** or **inconsistent**, it becomes difficult to rely on the information for planning or farmer support and SCL will not pay for such data.

Therefore, **high-quality data is essential for decision-making**.

5.1.4 Why the Data Matters for Farmer Business Development

The data collected by VCMs supports the development of a **stronger agricultural value chain**.

With **reliable farm data**, **SCL** can:

- **Forecast** future crop production volumes
- **Identify aggregation** opportunities for produce collection
- **Secure buyers** and **forward contracts**
- **Connect farmers** to **financial services**
- **Support crop insurance** programs
- **Monitor adoption** of regenerative agriculture practices – a key requirement for brand value

This information helps transform smallholder farmers from **isolated** producers into **participants in organized agricultural markets**.

Over time, **consistent data and accurate** collection allows farmers to demonstrate:

- **production** capacity
- crop **reliability**
- **farm management** practices

These **records** can help **farmers gain access** to:

- better market opportunities
- input supply systems
- agricultural financing

VCMs therefore play an **important** role not only as advisors but also as **stewards of reliable agricultural data that supports farmer prosperity and value chain development**.

VCM Data Collection Checklist

Stage	Data to Collect	Verification Method	Reporting Frequency
Seed Acquisition	Seed source, seed type, quantity, seed bank usage	VCM visit or farmer confirmation	Pre-season
Land Preparation	Land prepared, farm size verified, preparation timing	Field inspection + GPS	Before planting
Planting	Crop types, polyculture layout, seed quantities	Field visit	Planting stage
Germination	Germination success, crop population	Field inspection	Early crop growth
Crop Management	Weeding status, bio-input use, crop condition	Field visit	During crop growth
Harvest	Harvest dates, yield quantities, number of harvests	Field inspection	Harvest stage
Regenerative Practice Monitoring	Seed sourcing compliance, soil cover, tree presence, biodiversity indicators	Observation or photo evidence	All stages

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PLEASE NOTE, AS A COMPANY POLICY: - SCL WILL NOT PURCHASE INACURATE DATA OR DATA COLLECTED IN A FRADULENT MANNER